

05

Architecture of the Kingside Attack

Space, attackers, files, and entry squares: turning a closed center into a real operation.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will build attacks by counting pieces and contact points rather than pushing pawns because the king is nearby.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 025 | PAGE 4

Decode: Re1 and the e-file battery

A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

LESSON 026 | PAGE 8

Play: Re1 and the e-file battery

A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

LESSON 027 | PAGE 12

Decode: Queen and bishop entry squares

An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

LESSON 028 | PAGE 16

Play: Queen and bishop entry squares

An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

LESSON 029 | PAGE 20

Decode: Counting attacking and defending pieces

Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

LESSON 030 | PAGE 24

Play: Counting attacking and defending pieces

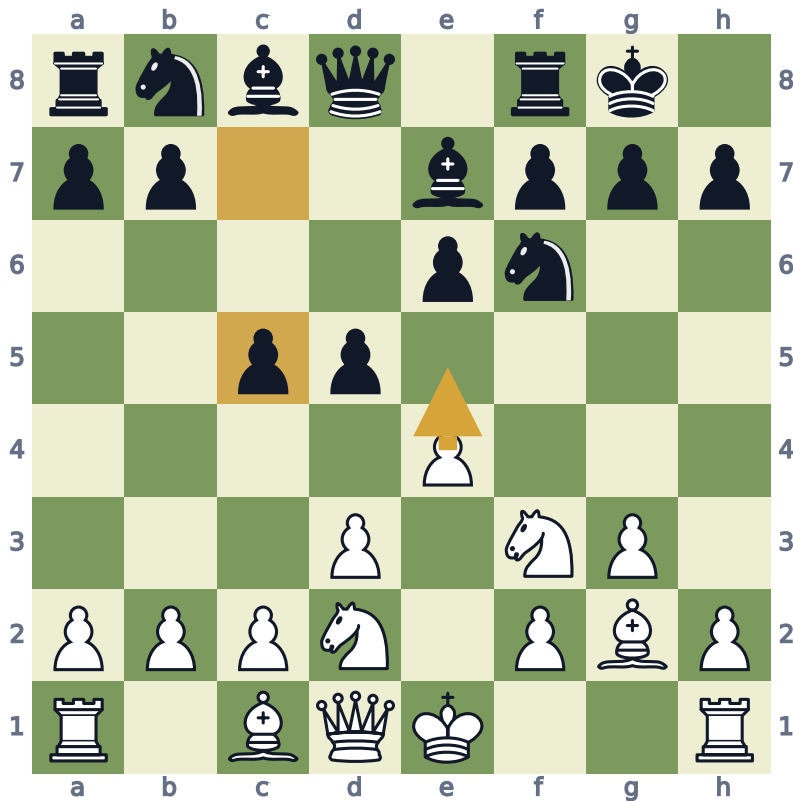
Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

VOLUME OBJECTIVE

You will build attacks by counting pieces and contact points rather than pushing pawns because the king is nearby.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Re1 and the e-file battery



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Re1 reinforces e4-e5, supports a later e5-e6 sacrifice, and gives the rook a role if the e-file opens.

DECISION RULE

What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the e-file closed, attacks the chain with ...f6, and uses queenside tempi before White's rook becomes active.

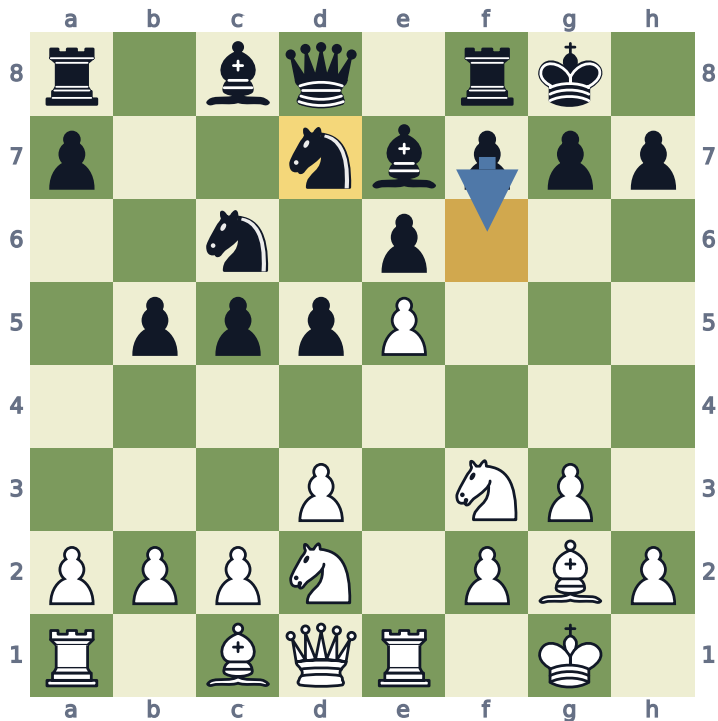
WHITE'S PLAN

White treats Re1 as preparation for a central rupture, not as proof that an attack already exists.

MEMORY RULE | A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Re1 reinforces e4-e5, supports a later e5-e6 sacrifice, and gives the rook a role if the e-file opens.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black keeps the e-file closed, attacks the chain with ...f6, and uses queenside tempi before White's rook becomes active.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White treats Re1 as preparation for a central rupture, not as proof that an attack already exists.

FAILURE MODE

Placing the rook on e1 and never creating a condition in which the file can open.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

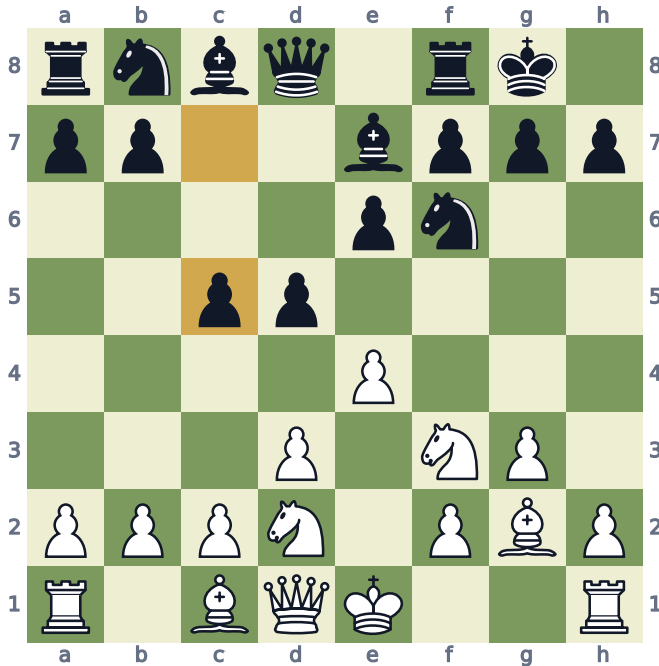
RULE | A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7



- Ngf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Re1 reinforces e4-e5, supports a later e5-e6 sacrifice, and gives the rook a role if the e-file opens.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it? White's attacking or positional plan is: White treats Re1 as preparation for a central rupture, not as proof that an attack already exists. The line fails as a template when: Placing the rook on e1 and never creating a condition in which the file can open.

STORE THIS | A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

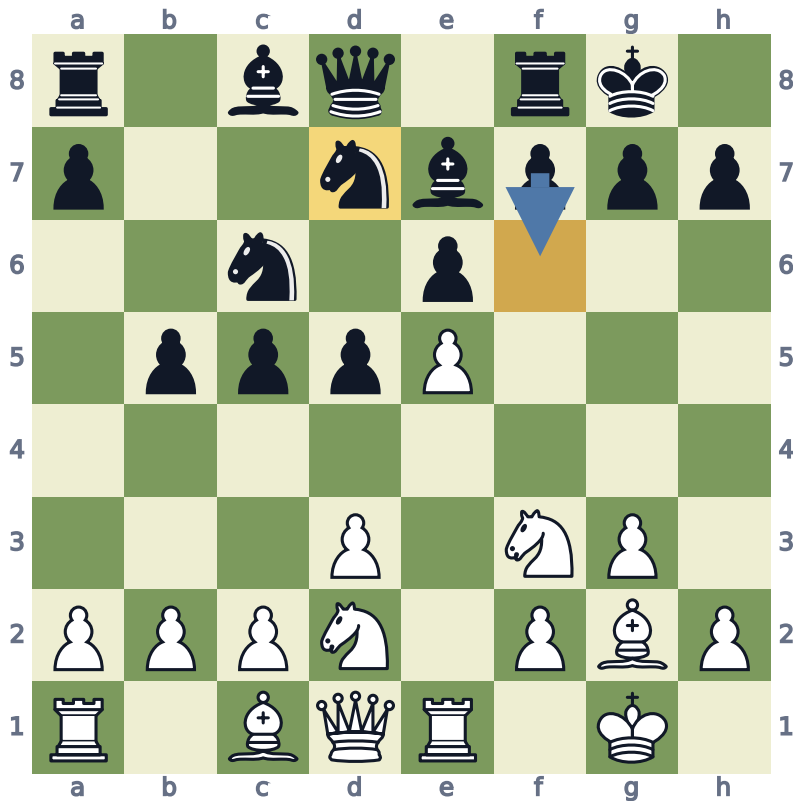
1. Re1 reinforces e4-e5, supports a later e5-e6 sacrifice, and gives the rook a role if the e-file opens. 2. Black keeps the e-file closed, attacks the chain with ...f6, and uses queenside tempi before White's rook becomes active. 3. White treats Re1 as preparation for a central rupture, not as proof that an attack already exists. 4. What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it? 5. Placing the rook on e1 and never creating a condition in which the file can open.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Re1 and the e-file battery



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Re1 reinforces e4-e5, supports a later e5-e6 sacrifice, and gives the rook a role if the e-file opens.

DECISION RULE

What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the e-file closed, attacks the chain with ...f6, and uses queenside tempi before White's rook becomes active.

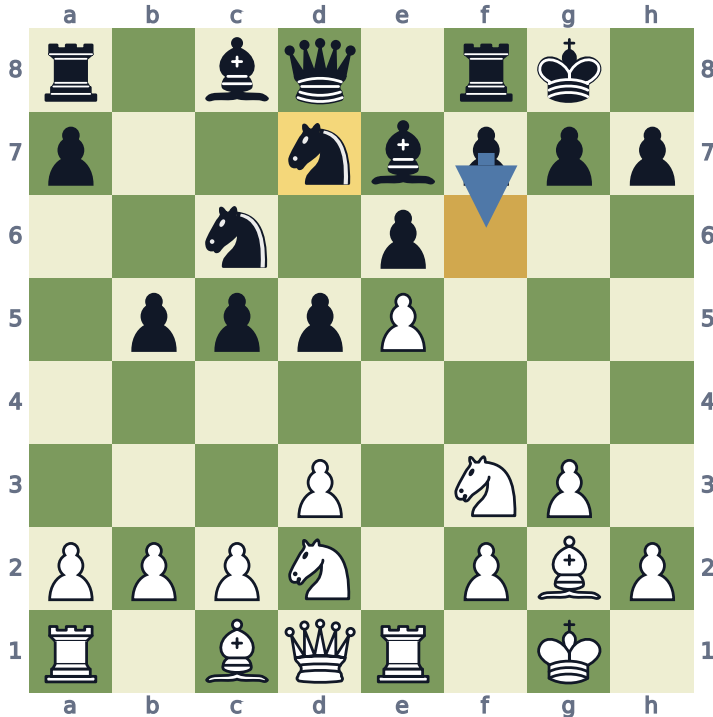
WHITE'S PLAN

White treats Re1 as preparation for a central rupture, not as proof that an attack already exists.

MEMORY RULE | A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Re1 reinforces e4-e5, supports a later e5-e6 sacrifice, and gives the rook a role if the e-file opens.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black keeps the e-file closed, attacks the chain with ...f6, and uses queenside tempi before White's rook becomes active.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White treats Re1 as preparation for a central rupture, not as proof that an attack already exists.

FAILURE MODE

Placing the rook on e1 and never creating a condition in which the file can open.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

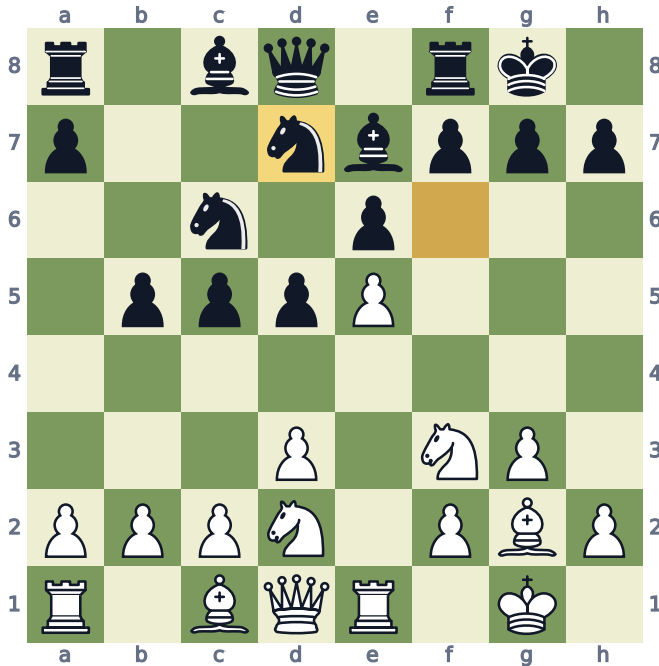
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Re1 reinforces e4-e5, supports a later e5-e6 sacrifice, and gives the rook a role if the e-file opens.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it? White's attacking or positional plan is: White treats Re1 as preparation for a central rupture, not as proof that an attack already exists. The line fails as a template when: Placing the rook on e1 and never creating a condition in which the file can open.

STORE THIS | A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

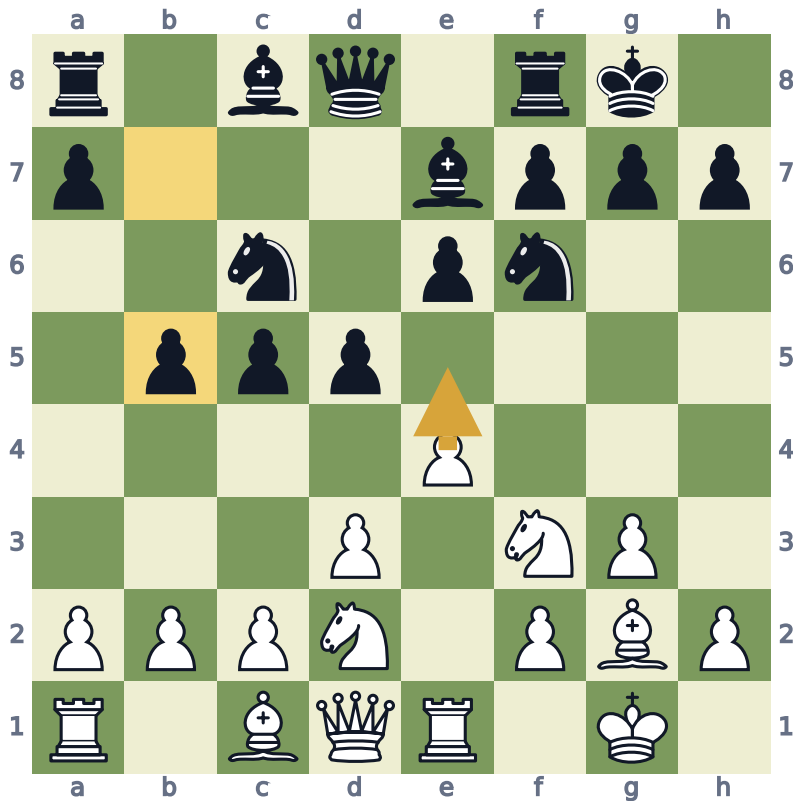
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Queen and bishop entry squares



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The attack needs queen access through e2, h5, or g4 and a useful diagonal for the c1 bishop; otherwise the pawns advance without heavy-piece support.

DECISION RULE

Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black controls entry squares, trades one attacking bishop, and opens the center while White's queen is traveling.

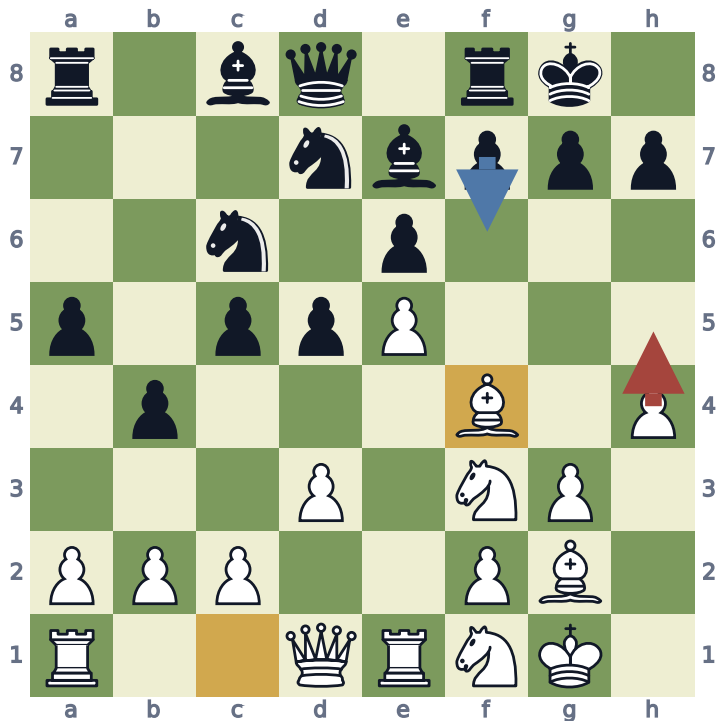
WHITE'S PLAN

White chooses Bf4, Qe2, and h5 in an order that avoids tempo attacks and creates a concrete threat.

MEMORY RULE | An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The attack needs queen access through e2, h5, or g4 and a useful diagonal for the c1 bishop; otherwise the pawns advance without heavy-piece support.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black controls entry squares, trades one attacking bishop, and opens the center while White's queen is traveling.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White chooses Bf4, Qe2, and h5 in an order that avoids tempo attacks and creates a concrete threat.

FAILURE MODE

Sending the queen to the kingside where a minor piece can attack it while Black gains central time.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

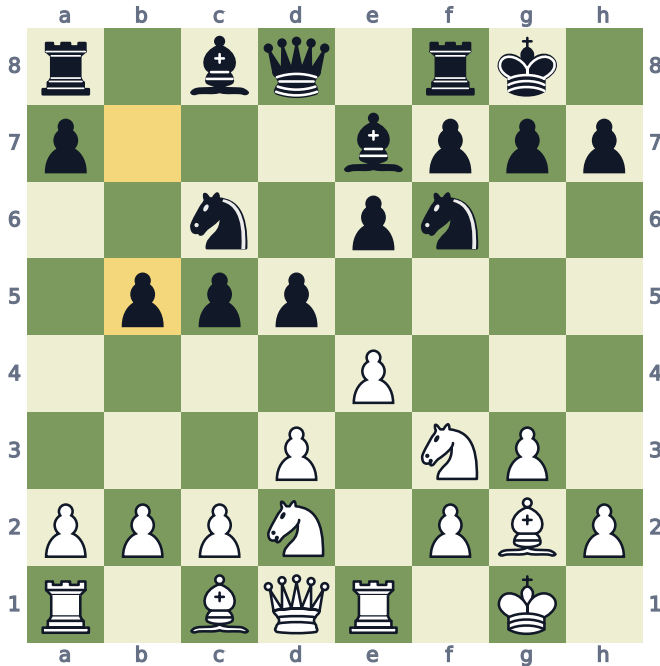
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Move-by-move meaning

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- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The attack needs queen access through e2, h5, or g4 and a useful diagonal for the c1 bishop; otherwise the pawns advance without heavy-piece support.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful? White's attacking or positional plan is: White chooses Bf4, Qe2, and h5 in an order that avoids tempo attacks and creates a concrete threat. The line fails as a template when: Sending the queen to the kingside where a minor piece can attack it while Black gains central time.

STORE THIS | An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

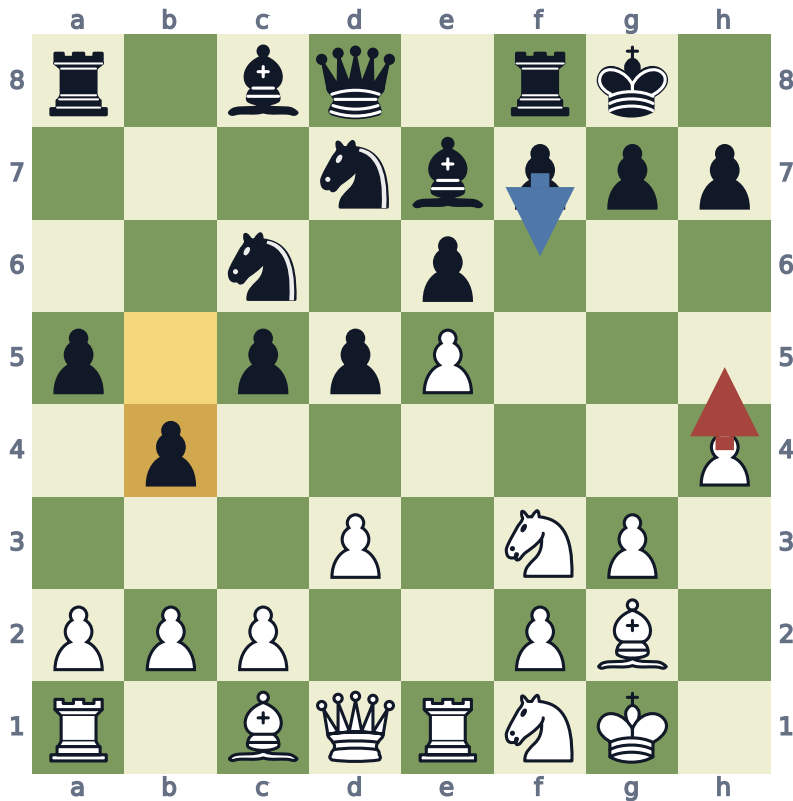
1. The attack needs queen access through e2, h5, or g4 and a useful diagonal for the c1 bishop; otherwise the pawns advance without heavy-piece support. 2. Black controls entry squares, trades one attacking bishop, and opens the center while White's queen is traveling. 3. White chooses Bf4, Qe2, and h5 in an order that avoids tempo attacks and creates a concrete threat. 4. Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful? 5. Sending the queen to the kingside where a minor piece can attack it while Black gains central time.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Queen and bishop entry squares



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The attack needs queen access through e2, h5, or g4 and a useful diagonal for the c1 bishop; otherwise the pawns advance without heavy-piece support.

DECISION RULE

Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

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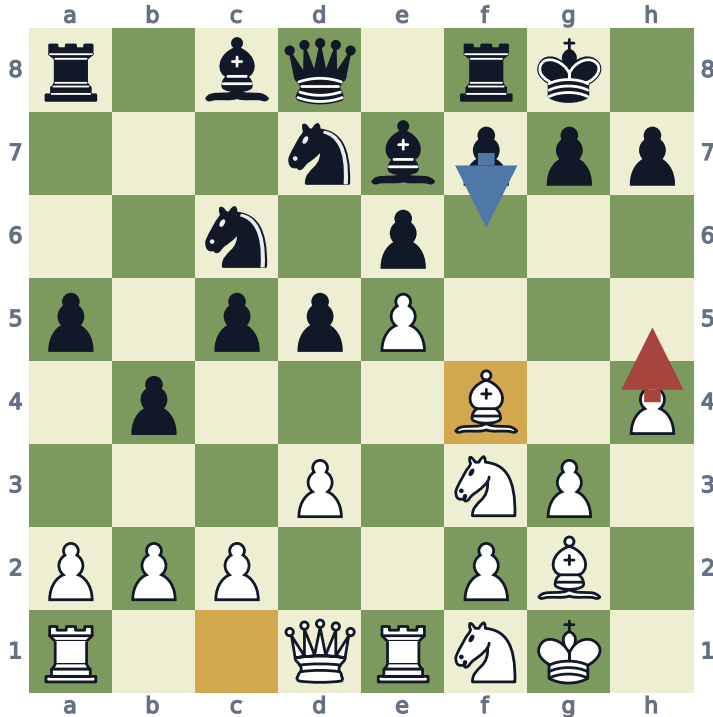
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White chooses Bf4, Qe2, and h5 in an order that avoids tempo attacks and creates a concrete threat.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The attack needs queen access through e2, h5, or g4 and a useful diagonal for the c1 bishop; otherwise the pawns advance without heavy-piece support.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black controls entry squares, trades one attacking bishop, and opens the center while White's queen is traveling.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White chooses Bf4, Qe2, and h5 in an order that avoids tempo attacks and creates a concrete threat.

FAILURE MODE

Sending the queen to the kingside where a minor piece can attack it while Black gains central time.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

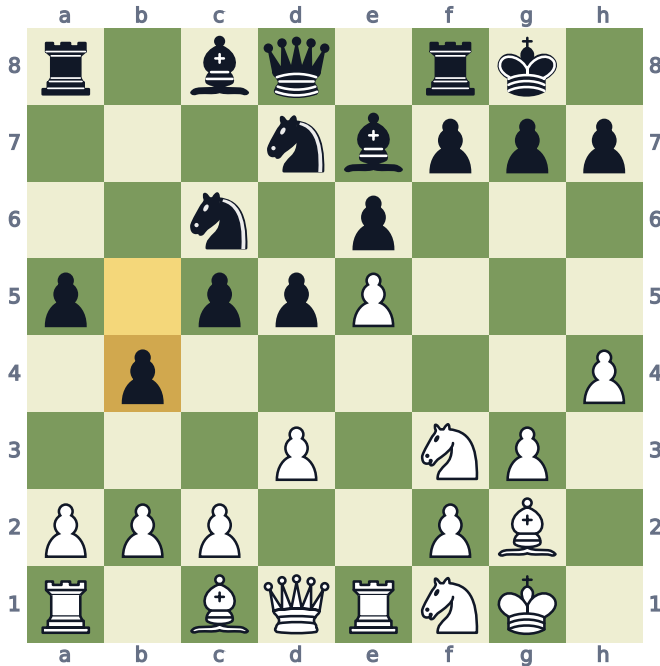
RULE | An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Bf4



- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The attack needs queen access through e2, h5, or g4 and a useful diagonal for the c1 bishop; otherwise the pawns advance without heavy-piece support.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful? White's attacking or positional plan is: White chooses Bf4, Qe2, and h5 in an order that avoids tempo attacks and creates a concrete threat. The line fails as a template when: Sending the queen to the kingside where a minor piece can attack it while Black gains central time.

STORE THIS | An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

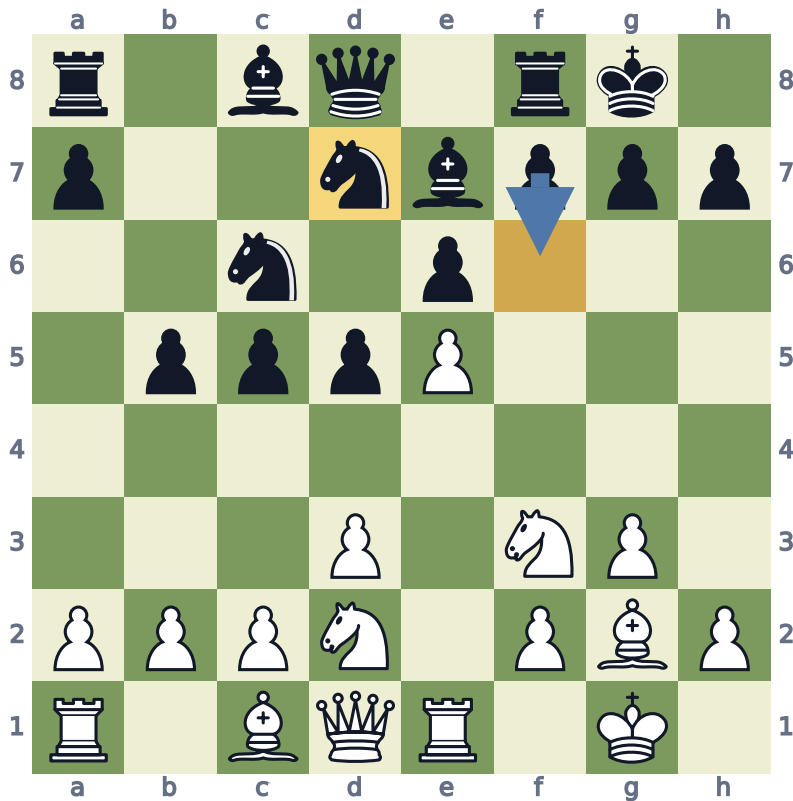
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Counting attacking and defending pieces

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Kingside space is not an attack by itself. White needs enough pieces near the king to exploit an opened file before Black's defenders arrive.

DECISION RULE

After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black transfers a knight or rook to the kingside, exchanges a key attacker, or creates a central threat that forces White to retreat.

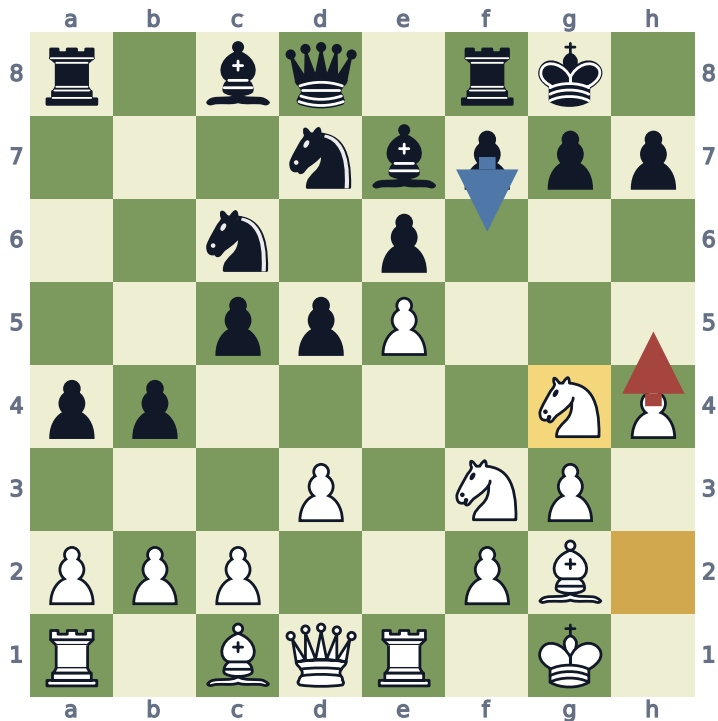
WHITE'S PLAN

White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders.

MEMORY RULE | Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Kingside space is not an attack by itself. White needs enough pieces near the king to exploit an opened file before Black's defenders arrive.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black transfers a knight or rook to the kingside, exchanges a key attacker, or creates a central threat that forces White to retreat.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders.

FAILURE MODE

Counting advanced pawns as attackers even when no piece can use the file they open.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

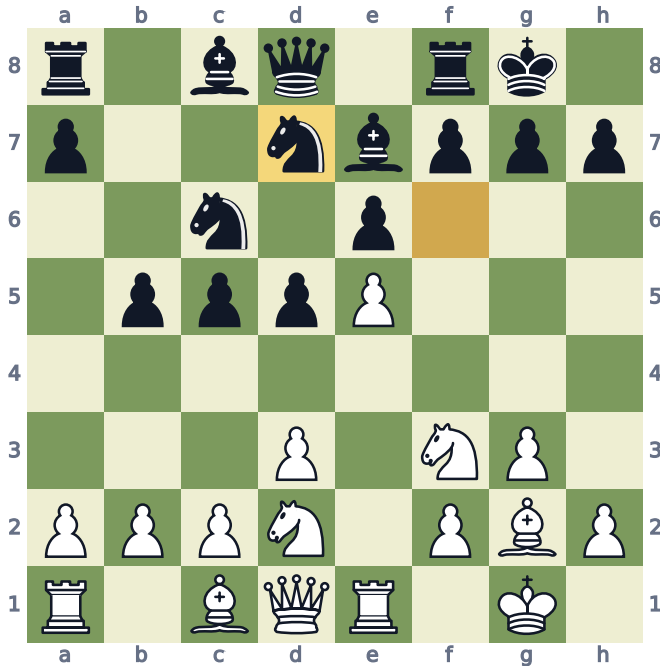
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. Ng4



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Kingside space is not an attack by itself. White needs enough pieces near the king to exploit an opened file before Black's defenders arrive.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them? White's attacking or positional plan is: White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders. The line fails as a template when: Counting advanced pawns as attackers even when no piece can use the file they open.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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ANSWER KEY

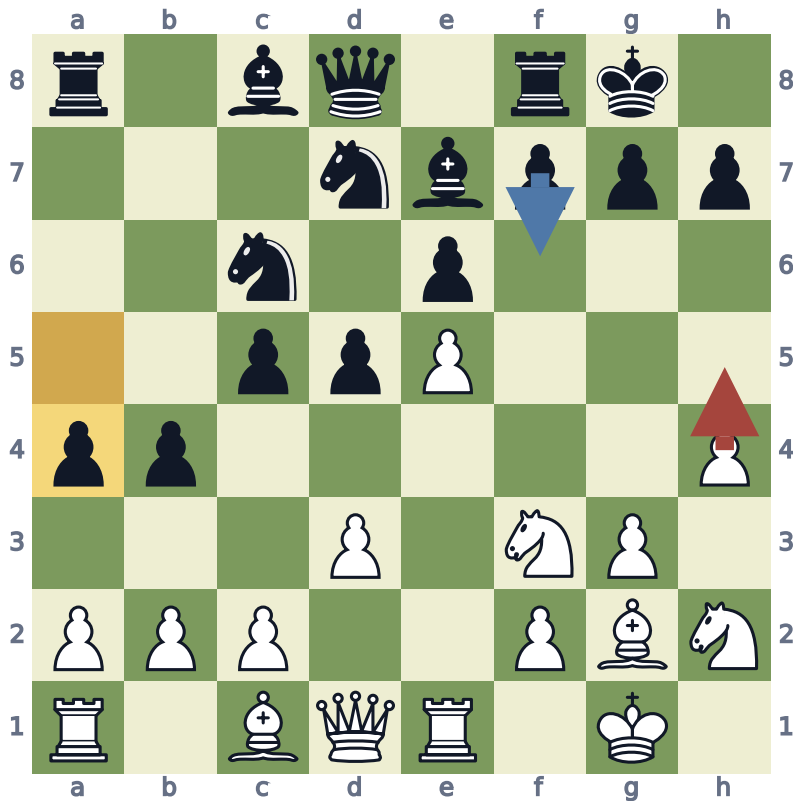
1. Kingside space is not an attack by itself. White needs enough pieces near the king to exploit an opened file before Black's defenders arrive. 2. Black transfers a knight or rook to the kingside, exchanges a key attacker, or creates a central threat that forces White to retreat. 3. White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders. 4. After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them? 5. Counting advanced pawns as attackers even when no piece can use the file they open.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Counting attacking and defending pieces



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

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BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

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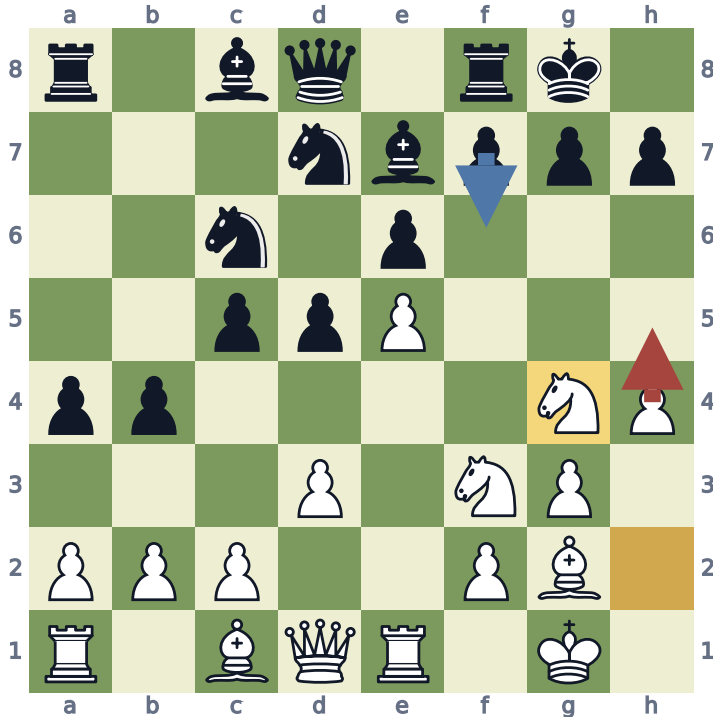
WHITE'S PLAN

White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders.

MEMORY RULE | Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Kingside space is not an attack by itself. White needs enough pieces near the king to exploit an opened file before Black's defenders arrive.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black transfers a knight or rook to the kingside, exchanges a key attacker, or creates a central threat that forces White to retreat.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders.

FAILURE MODE

Counting advanced pawns as attackers even when no piece can use the file they open.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

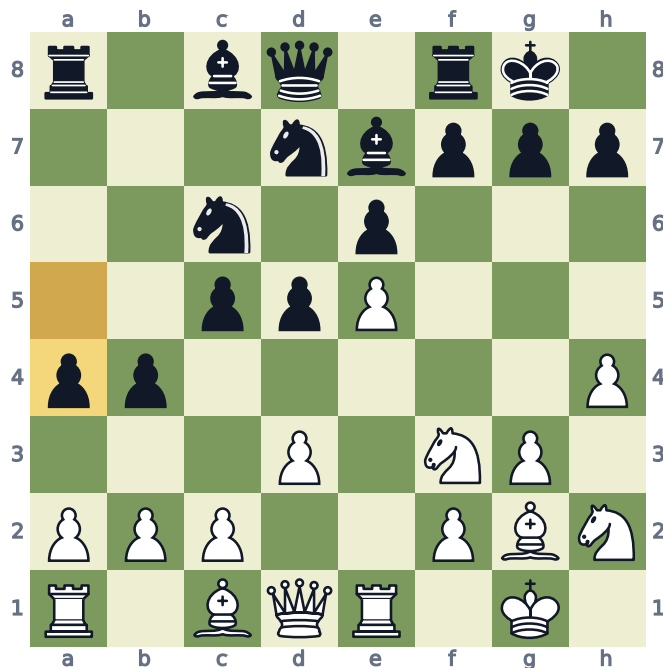
RULE | Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. Ng4



- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- N1h2: White reroutes a knight to h2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- a4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Kingside space is not an attack by itself. White needs enough pieces near the king to exploit an opened file before Black's defenders arrive.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them? White's attacking or positional plan is: White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders. The line fails as a template when: Counting advanced pawns as attackers even when no piece can use the file they open.

STORE THIS | Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Kingside space is not an attack by itself. White needs enough pieces near the king to exploit an opened file before Black's defenders arrive. 2. Black transfers a knight or rook to the kingside, exchanges a key attacker, or creates a central threat that forces White to retreat. 3. White counts pieces that can join within one move and chooses a pawn contact only when the attackers outnumber useful defenders. 4. After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them? 5. Counting advanced pawns as attackers even when no piece can use the file they open.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 025 Decode: Re1 and the e-file battery

Prompt: What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it?

Recall: A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

LESSON 026 Play: Re1 and the e-file battery

Prompt: What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it?

Recall: A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

LESSON 027 Decode: Queen and bishop entry squares

Prompt: Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful?

Recall: An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

LESSON 028 Play: Queen and bishop entry squares

Prompt: Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful?

Recall: An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

LESSON 029 Decode: Counting attacking and defending pieces

Prompt: After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them?

Recall: Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

LESSON 030 Play: Counting attacking and defending pieces

Prompt: After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them?

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Re1 and the e-file battery

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

Decision: What pawn exchange will open the e-file, and which king or piece will then stand on it?

Memory: A rook belongs behind the pawn break that may open its file.

CARD 2

Queen and bishop entry squares

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Bf4

Decision: Which queen square is safe, and which bishop move makes that square tactically meaningful?

Memory: An attack becomes real when the queen has an entry square and the minor pieces control its escape squares.

CARD 3

Counting attacking and defending pieces

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. Ng4

Decision: After the next pawn exchange, how many white pieces attack the opened squares and how many black pieces defend them?

Memory: Open a line only when your pieces, not merely your pawns, can enter first.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
025 Decode: Re1 and the e-file battery	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
026 Play: Re1 and the e-file battery	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
027 Decode: Queen and bishop entry squares	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
028 Play: Queen and bishop entry squares	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
029 Decode: Counting attacking and defending pieces	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
030 Play: Counting attacking and defending pieces	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.